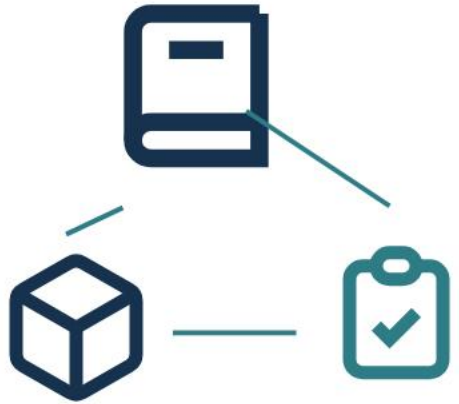
Yangyang Xiao | z5707699 | COMM5030 | Assessment 2

Beyond Toy Counts



Measuring Families' Access to Play Resources

A short-survey framework for Joy of Giving

Proposed measurement design | family-reported access

An evidence-informed indicator review

Desk-based design appraisal

No survey administered

Source base

5 official documents

3 institutions

Course impact frameworks

General guidance; no toy-specific measure has been validated.

Appraisal criteria

Relevance
Does it answer the research question?

Burden
What must a carer recall or explain?

Feasibility
Can the team collect and use it?

Interpretation
Which claims can it support?

Sources: Bjarkefur et al. 2021; ONS n.d.; GDS n.d.a–c. Five documents, not five empirical studies.

Measure access beyond redistribution

A proposed pathway for one short-term social outcome

ACTIVITY		OUTPUT		INTENDED OUTCOME
Toy redistribution	→	**Items received**	→	**Reported access**
What the programme does		What it delivers		What families say changed

The output-to-outcome link requires evidence.

Satisfaction describes the service experience.

A positive experience can coexist with unchanged access.

Course framework: Nguyen 2026b, Week 3, pp.25–31. Proposed pathway; child development is outside scope.

Define access before writing questions

Candidate dimensions for review and testing

Availability	Can the family obtain resources when needed?
Affordability	Does cost prevent access to needed resources?
Suitability	Do the items fit the child's play needs?

Actual use adds context. It is not a validated access score.

Author's proposed operationalisation. Definition/context guidance: ONS n.d.; systems lens: Nguyen 2026c.

Comparing measurement options

Qualitative appraisal against the research question

Option	What it contributes	Trade-off
Distribution records	Describe reach and activity	Indirect relevance to access
Satisfaction item	Describe service experience	Does not ask about change
Access-change item	Ask about perceived change	Requires recall of an earlier period
Short set + comment	Add barriers, fit and explanation	More time and coding; pilot first

Keep only questions that inform a decision or a report claim.

Author appraisal, not measured ratings. Design principles: Bjarkefur et al. 2021; GDS n.d.a.

Five questions, each with a clear purpose

01 **Access change**
Easier, harder or unchanged?

02 **Cost barrier**
How often did cost prevent access?

03 **Suitability**
How well did the received items fit?

04 **Recent use**
Use during the last seven days

05 **Explanation**
What changed, and what helped or hindered?

Interpret separately

Proposed: invite adult carers four weeks after one visit.

Define the reference periods.
Keep valid “not sure” options.
Leave options unselected.
Allow review before submitting.

No total access score.

Draft items; pilot required. Sources: Bjarkefur et al. 2021; ONS n.d.; GDS n.d.a–c. Full wording: Appendix A.

Reported change has limits

A recalled change report is not a causal estimate.

Limitation	Reporting safeguard
Recall and selective response	Specify the period; say “among responding families”.
No baseline or counterfactual	Do not attribute the change to the programme.
General methods guidance	Test the items in this family and toy context.

Records and interviews strengthen interpretation; they do not establish causality.

Counterfactual reasoning: Bjarkefur et al. 2021, ch.3. Other risks: A1 and Nguyen 2026a.

Turn the framework into a team deliverable

Describe reported change.
Match every claim to the evidence.

01

Agree with the client

Priority outcome, target carers and reference period.

02

Test with adult carers

Understanding, response options and completion burden.

03

Revise and triangulate

Refine items; compare with records or interviews.

Indicator guide + draft survey + reporting rules

For the Impact Report and Media Collateral

Proposed A3 work plan. Pilot principles: Bjarkefur et al. 2021. Check/review guidance: GDS n.d.c.

References | methods and design

Bjarkefur, K., de Andrade, L.C., Daniels, B. and Jones, M.R. (2021)

Development Research in Practice: The DIME Analytics Data Handbook.

World Bank, chs.3–4, source version viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/worldbank/dime-data-handbook

Office for National Statistics (ONS) (n.d.)

Question anatomy example. ONS Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/ONSdigital/design-system

Government Digital Service (GDS) (n.d.a)

Question pages. GOV.UK Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system

Government Digital Service (GDS) (n.d.b)

Radios. GOV.UK Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system

References | guidance and course context

Government Digital Service (GDS) (n.d.c)

Check answers. GOV.UK Design System.

Official source repository, viewed 19 October 2026. https://github.com/alphagov/govuk-design-system

Nguyen, L. (2026a)

Week 2: Action Research & Data Collection.

COMM5030, UNSW Sydney, lecture guide, pp.18–19 and 29–30. Supplied course material.

Nguyen, L. (2026b)

Week 3: Social Impact Measurement.

COMM5030, UNSW Sydney, lecture slides, pp.25–31 and 42. Supplied course material.

Nguyen, L. (2026c)

Week 5: Systems Thinking.

COMM5030, UNSW Sydney, lecture slides, pp.17–28. Supplied course material.

Preparation: ChatGPT assisted drafting; Image Gen informed style A; PPT Master supported editable export.

Appendix A | draft parent survey

Proposed: invite adult carers four weeks after a selected visit. Answer for one child; record no child identifier. Participation is optional and does not affect support.

1. Access change

Compared with the four weeks before that visit, how easy was it to obtain suitable toys or books for this child in the four weeks after it?

Much harder; a little harder; no change; a little easier; much easier; not sure.

2. Cost barrier

In the four weeks after that visit, how often did cost prevent you getting toys or books this child needed?

Never; sometimes; often; always; not sure; prefer not to answer.

3. Suitability

How suitable were the items received for this child's play needs?

Not at all; slightly; moderately; very; extremely; not sure; not used yet.

4. Recent use

In the last seven days, on how many days did this child use an item from that visit?

Zero to seven days; not sure.

5. Explanation (optional)

What, if anything, changed in this child's access? What helped or made access difficult?

Author-drafted items; not validated. Pilot wording, periods and options. Design guidance: ONS n.d.; GDS n.d.a–b.

Appendix B | indicator and reporting guide

Item-specific denominators. Keep unknown and skipped answers separate. No total score.

Item	Summary rule	Interpretation boundary
Access change	Report each response category and valid item count.	Recalled change, not programme effect.
Cost barrier	Report frequency categories for the stated period.	Current barrier, not evidence of cost reduction.
Suitability	Report the distribution of fit ratings.	Perceived fit, not child development.
Recent use	Report zero–seven days; show unknown separately.	Use of received items, not access improvement.
Open explanation	Code themes; illustrate with anonymised examples.	Comments do not estimate population prevalence.

Author's proposed reporting protocol. Missing/review guidance: GDS n.d.b–c. Full source trail retained with project.